
AITIT TRAINING INSIGHTS

THE HYROX RACE READINESS FORMULA

We don't believe in a silver bullet that works for everyone. But we have seen many training journeys fall short of what the athlete hoped for — and it usually traces back to one of three things:



TOO LONG A RUNWAY

Training kicks off six or more months out. The finish line feels distant, the edge dulls, and motivation quietly leaks away long before race day.



LACK OF FOCUS

Certain elements get trained hard while others are neglected — a strong engine with no top end, or plenty of strength but no ability to run under fatigue.



LACK OF INTENSITY

The body and heart never spend enough time working in fatigue, at a high pulse. Race pace becomes a shock rather than a rehearsal.

So “all it takes is training” might not be entirely true. Which is why we break the formula down — the **exercise types** that build the engine, and the **structure** that keeps you in it.

THE BUILDING BLOCKS

FIVE EXERCISE TYPES

The first three build the aerobic engine and must be part of every serious program. The other two are powerful additions, dialed to your goals — a sharp race focus like sled push & pull performance, or simply general health, fitness and aesthetics.

THE ENGINE · NON-NEGOTIABLE

01 ZONE 2

Longer, aerobic effort — which means staying out of the high-intensity zones. Steered by heart rate: keep the average at 65–75% of your true max (approx. 220 bpm – age), a pace at which you could still hold a conversation. Aim for 60+ minutes, especially for your main Zone 2 session of the week. Runs can be alternated with cycling or even the row / ski erg.

02 RUN INTERVALS

Intense efforts separated by short breaks. Common sets: 400m (10–20×), 1km or 1.2km (4–8×), 2km (3–5×). Breaks of 1–2 min at a moderate walking pace. Total work runs 30–60 min, ideally with a warm-up and cool-down at relaxed pace (~1km each).

03 WORK INTERVALS

Intense efforts separated by short breaks — typically a mix of row erg, ski erg and running, commonly combined with burpee jumps, lunges and wall balls. Shorten the breaks over time: races are won on tired legs and in the transitions between runs and exercises. Total work runs 45–60 min.

THE ADDITIONS · YOUR CALL

04 STRENGTH

Preference-led. Can — but doesn't need to — carry a Hyrox focus: lower-body and leg strength, grip strength, sled push & pull work.

05 MOBILITY & RECOVERY

Preference-led. Effective options include, but are not limited to, yoga, stretching, mobility, massage or sauna.

HOW IT'S BUILT

THREE WAVES TO RACE DAY

Three training waves are the core of the build — long enough to develop the engine, dense enough to hold focus and motivation. Each runs four (at most five) weeks: 12–15 weeks in total, rounded off by a one-to-two-week taper before the race. An optional off-week can sit between waves.

PREP

FLEXIBLE

WAVE 1

4–5 WKS

WAVE 2

4–5 WKS

WAVE 3

4–5 WKS

TAPER

1–2 WKS

PREP BEFORE WAVE 1

Mostly strength, complemented with a few Zone 2 sessions. This can just as easily be a no-sport stretch — whatever your body craves before the real work begins.

WAVE 1 BUILD THE FOUNDATION

Heaviest on Zone 2, complemented mainly with strength and the first intervals. Our preference is to **start with run intervals** — **no hybrid work yet**. This wave lays the aerobic foundation everything else is built on.

WAVE 2 SHIFT TO INTENSITY

The focus moves to interval sessions. Five core sessions a week: **two run intervals, two work (hybrid) intervals and one long run**. We complement this with two strength sessions and, ideally, one shorter Zone 2 run.

WAVE 3 ENDURE THE PAIN

Same split and focus as Wave 2, with intensity pushed up 5–10%. Where 10–12×400m was the norm, we now move to 15–20. **This is where we learn to endure.**

TAPER 1–2 WEEKS BEFORE RACE

Volume comes down, sharpness stays. The engine is built — the taper is about arriving fresh, not flat.